

U.S., Israeli forces strike Iran

SUPREME LEADER KILLED AS WAR THREATENS ENTIRE REGION

A vow to end wars is left in the dust

BY ANA CEBALLOS AND GAVIN J. QUINTON

WASHINGTON — For a decade, President Trump promised to end what he calls forever wars, casting himself as a leader opposed to prolonged conflicts in the Middle East and who would rather pursue peace in the world.

Now, early in his second term, Trump is taking military action against Iran that could expand well beyond a limited effort to halt the country's nuclear program.

In a video posted on Truth Social, the commander-in-chief said American forces also plan to “raze their missile industry to the ground” and “annihilate their navy.” He warned members of Iran's military to surrender or “face certain death.” And urged the Iranian people to take the moment as an opportunity to rise up against their government.

“This regime will soon learn that no one should challenge the strength and might of the United States armed forces,” Trump said.

A few hours after relaying that message, Trump confirmed in a separate social media post that Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, the supreme leader of Iran, was among those killed by U.S. and Israeli strikes. Even so, Trump said “the heavy and pinpoint bombing” would continue in Iran “as long as necessary to achieve our objective of PEACE THROUGHOUT THE MIDDLE EAST AND, INDEED, THE WORLD!”

Trump, who has been considering a strike on Iran for several weeks, acknowledged he reached the decision to attack Iran while aware of the human toll that could come with it.

“The lives of courageous American heroes may be [See Pivot, A4]



SMOKE RISES on the Tehran skyline on Saturday. Hundreds were killed and injured in Iran, officials said.

Khamenei ruled his country with an iron grip for decades



IRAN'S Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was killed in Saturday's attack.

In ‘Tehrangeles,’ a day of joy and anxiety

BY CORINNE PURTILL

Reza Khaleghian, 70, came bursting through the door of Naab Cafe on Saturday morning, phone pressed to his ear, fist held in the air, screaming the news in Farsi at anyone who would listen: “Khamenei is dead!”

Soon, President Trump would confirm the death of

Iran's supreme leader in a historic attack by the United States and Israel. A sea of flag-waving revelers would later fill the intersection of Wilshire Boulevard and Veteran Avenue.

But as bombs fell 7,500 miles away in Tehran, members of West L.A.'s Iranian American community spent Saturday celebrating a day some had been awaiting for nearly half a century.

“This is a fantastic day we could not even imagine in our dreams,” said Beha Pangrazio, 35. She had emigrated from Tehran 10 years ago and brought her husband, infant son and mother to celebrate in Westwood, the epicenter of L.A.'s sprawling Iranian diaspora. “Hopefully the regime will change, the shah will return back home and we will have a glorious future for Iran.”

The Greater Los Angeles area is home to the largest concentration of people of Iranian descent outside Iran. Since the Islamic Revolution in 1979, it has served as a capital for exiles. By 2019, more than half of Iranian immigrants to the U.S. lived in California, with 29% — nearly 140,000 people — living in Los Angeles County alone, according to the Migration Policy Institute. [See Reaction, A7]

BY NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who was killed in the U.S.-Israeli attack on Iran on Saturday, had over more than 30 years in power demonized the United States, called for the destruction of Israel and maintained an ironclad grip on Iran's politics while advancing its influence across the Middle East.

President Trump announced Khamenei's death on Saturday on Truth Social. Iran also said he was killed.

As Iran's spiritual leader and its highest authority, Khamenei, 86, was the ultimate arbiter in state affairs, including the economy, education and defense. He was the region's longest-serving head of state and the second holder of the post of supreme leader in Iran.

He furthered the foreign policy of his predecessor and founder of the Islamic Republic, Ayatollah Ruhollah Khomeini, pitting Iran against the combined military might of the U.S. and Israel. [See Khamenei, A6]

Iran hits back after surprise attack

BY NABIH BULOS, ANA CEBALLOS AND RAMIN MOSTAGHIM

TEHRAN — The U.S. and Israel pummeled Iran early Saturday in an attack aimed at razing the Islamic Republic's nuclear ambitions and thwarting its efforts to influence the Middle East through proxies such as Hezbollah and Hamas.

Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei was killed in the attack, according to President Trump, who in a post on Truth Social wrote that “one of the most evil people in History, is dead. This is not only Justice for the people of Iran, but for all Great Americans.”

More than 200 people were killed in Iran and hundreds more injured, according to Iran's Red Crescent.

The attacks spurred a furious Iranian retaliation, with multiple barrages striking Israel, a number of Persian Gulf nations and Jordan; and fulfilled long-standing fears that a confrontation with Iran would plunge the region into war.

Reports of Khamenei's death prompted diverse reactions worldwide: In portions of Tehran and Los Angeles, home to a large Persian population, people took to the streets to celebrate. In New York, protesters gathered at Times Square to denounce the attack.

The attack came eight weeks after U.S. forces deployed by Trump toppled Venezuelan President Nicolás Maduro, and Trump said Saturday's operation also presented a chance for regime change.

Addressing the Iranian people, Trump said, “When we are finished, take over your government. It will be yours to take.”

Trump made the comments in an eight-minute prerecorded video. “This will be probably your only chance for generations,” Trump said, adding, “For many years, you have asked for America's help, but you never got it. No president was willing to do what I am willing to do tonight.”

The Iranian government confirmed Khamenei's death. [See Strike, A4]

Lawmakers seek vote on war powers

Democrats and a few Republicans push resolution to curtail Trump's ability to conduct strikes in Iran. **A7**

What's at stake for oil markets

The Islamic Republic pumps 3.3 million barrels a day, making it the fourth-largest producer in OPEC. **A8**

An educator, a failed deal and an FBI probe

BY BRITTNY MEJIA, HOWARD BLUME AND RICHARD WINTON

Alberto Carvalho and Debra Kerr's roots date back to their days together in the Florida education community.

Carvalho was the charismatic leader of Miami-Dade County schools, and Kerr was a well-known figure in the private sector, working for firms doing business with school systems.

Carvalho gave the keynote speech at a summit for superintendents sponsored by Age of Learning, where

Kerr worked at the time as the head of sales.

Over the years, Kerr shared Carvalho's Facebook posts to her own page, congratulating him on winning an award and often using the hashtag “#leadershipmatters.” Three years ago, Kerr posed for a smiling photo beside Carvalho, who had become the superintendent in Los Angeles, during what she described as his “brilliant” opening of schools address.

In 2023, Carvalho and Kerr became linked through another project. By now, Carvalho was head of the [See Carvalho, A10]



CHRISTINA HOUSE L.A. Times
VISUAL ARTIST Judy Baca is shown with her artwork “La Salsera.”

Artist denies misuse of funds

Judy Baca's former staff members allege she used the nonprofit art center SPARC for her personal gain. **ENTERTAINMENT, E6**

Detainees tell of poor conditions

ICE has been holding hundreds of children at the immigration detention center in Dilley, Texas. **NATION, A12**

Dental care poses a crisis to seniors

Proposed Medi-Cal cuts could make oral health care even more unaffordable, Steve Lopez writes. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Mostly sunny; warm. L.A. Basin: 81/56. **B8**

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Lachman fire was not put out, firefighter says

BY ALENE TCHEKMEDYIAN

A Los Angeles firefighter said in sworn testimony that he sounded an alarm about the inadequate mop-up of the Lachman fire — and was blown off by a captain — days before the embers reignited into the deadly Palisades fire.

Scott Pike, a 23-year LAFD veteran, was assigned to roll up hoses that had been left out overnight at the scene of the Lachman fire.

Around 8:45 a.m. on Jan. 2, 2025, Pike saw about five areas that still were smok-

ing, he testified in January in a lawsuit brought by Palisades fire victims against the city and the state.

At one ash pit, Pike said, “I didn't even want to use my gloved hand because it was hot. So I just kicked it with my boot to kind of expose it, and there was, like red hot, like, coals ... that was still smoldering. And I even heard crackling.”

Pike's dramatic retelling, which attorneys representing the city initially blocked from release along with transcripts of deposition testimony from 11 other firefighters, corroborates previous [See Lachman fire, A11]